

If you're working on a graphic for printing, you will be using the Cyan, Magenta, Yellow and Black (CMYK) channels—while RGB represents the primary colours of light, CMYK represents the primary colours of ink pigments.

For the most part, you can do to a channel what you can do to layers—paint, apply filters, tweak brightness and contrast, and so on.

Here's what you can do with the Channels Palette:

- Select individual channels for editing
- Turn channel visibility on and off using the “eye” icon next to it
- Create a new Alpha Channel that will define the transparent parts of the image (refer to Chapters 3 and 5 for more on Alpha Channels)
- Turn selections into channels by clicking on the Save Selection As Channel button 
- Turn channels into selections by clicking on the Load Channel As Selection button —for example, you could select all the blue areas of the image, even the partially blue ones, by loading the blue channel as a selection

Again, you will get more comfortable with channels as you read on.



The Paths Palette

1.3.4 The Paths Palette

When you reach Chapter 7, you will begin working with Paths, which let you create shapes that can be resized infinitely without any distortion. The Paths palette is (obviously) going to play a role here.

Here's what you can do with the Paths Palette:

- Create and delete paths
- Convert paths to selections and vice versa
- Fill the path with the foreground colour
- *Stroke* the path—that is, paint on its edge using different tools such as brushes and erasers